



Child Safeguarding Policy



A PRESENTATION BY,

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- **Purpose of the Policy**

The policy affirms CRY's commitment to safeguarding children by ensuring their safety, care, protection, and welfare in all its practices. It aims to establish protection mechanisms, a standard code of conduct, and procedures for all CRY staff and associates, ensuring everyone is informed and empowered to protect children from harm.

- **Guiding Principles**

- * Non-discrimination and respect for all children.
- * Best interest of the child is the primary consideration.
- * Encourage meaningful participation by children.
- * Zero tolerance for child abuse.

- **Applicability**

This policy applies to all CRY staff, associates, visitors, and board members.

- **Code of Conduct**

Musts: Respect, informed consent, privacy, risk management, and confidentiality.

Must nots: Abuse, inappropriate contact, discrimination, sharing child data, or engaging outside approved boundaries.



- **Key Responsibilities**

Awareness: Ensure all CRY representatives are aware of and adhere to the policy.

Prevention: Safe recruitment, informed consent, responsible use of child data, and respectful media practices.

Reporting: Mandatory reporting of suspected abuse within 24 hours, documented and confidential, per SOP.

Responding: Investigate reports within 48 hours, ensuring child safety and legal compliance. Retaliation against reporters is strictly prohibited.

- **Administration**

The HR function, along with the Designate Authority, will administer this policy. It will be reviewed every three years or earlier if needed.

ANNEXURE 1: REFERENCE GUIDE FOR STATUTORY COMPLIANCES

Overview: SOPs on statutory compliance under CRY's CSP reflect management's duty to align with legal frameworks and raise awareness. Child protection is a shared responsibility of NGOs, government, families, and society.

Types of Compliances:

1. Direct Legal Compliances
2. Indirect Legal Compliances

Direct Legal Compliances: 1. POCSO Act, 2012 protects all children under 18 from sexual abuse, harassment, and exploitation. Gender-neutral law. Strict punishments including jail and fines. Covers: Sexual assault (penetrative & non-penetrative) Sexual harassment (touch, gestures, words), child pornography.

2. Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006 prohibits marriage of girls under 18 and boys under 21. Such marriages are voidable by the child. Punishment for adult males marrying a child and facilitators: Up to 2 years imprisonment Fine up to ₹1,00,000.

3. The Juvenile Justice Act, 2015 came into effect in January 2016, replacing the 2000 Act. It introduced the term "child in conflict with law" instead of "juvenile," defined "surrendered" and "orphaned" children, and clarified the roles of the Juvenile Justice Board and Child Welfare Committee. Refer to Rule 60 (page 12) for definitions.



Indirect Compliances:

The RTE Act, 2009 ensures free and compulsory education but doesn't directly address child abuse. However, its guidelines aim to eliminate corporal punishment through measures like creating monitoring cells.

The Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986 bans employment of children below 14 and restricts hazardous work for those above 14. It prohibits around 13 occupations and 51 processes, including transport work, port operations, cement manufacturing, and electronics soldering.

The Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 was an important landmark, which made the registration of births, deaths and still births compulsory across the country.

Child Protection in India: Legal, Policy & Media Overview

1. Legal Safeguards:

- POCSO Act, IPC, JJ Act: Prohibit child abuse, exploitation, trafficking, and disclosure of child victim identities.
- CrPC & IT Act: Ban media from revealing identities of victims; criminalize child pornography and online abuse.
- Model Rule 99: Ensures confidentiality and safe record handling of juvenile cases.

2. Media & Representation of Children:

- Press Council Guidelines & Delhi HC Rules: Media must not identify or sensationalize child victims; interviews require informed consent.
- CRY & Broadcasting Standards: Promote child dignity and rights; visuals should protect anonymity. ASCI Code: Forbids harmful or exploitative ads targeting children.

3. Child Welfare Schemes & Policies:

- National Policy for Children, ICPS, RTE Act, Mid-Day Meal, ICDS: Ensure education, nutrition, protection, and development.
- Special Schemes: UJJAWALA, Sabla, and others target trafficking, adolescent empowerment, and girl child welfare.

4. International Commitment:

- India upholds the “UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC)”, reinforcing its domestic legal and policy framework.

ANNEXURE 3: PHOTOGRAPHY AND VIDEOGRAPHY

1. Privacy and Dignity

- Children's privacy, dignity, and development are important and must be protected.
- They must be treated respectfully, be properly clothed, and not subjected to any form of distress.
- Represent facts honestly; avoid exposing children to vulnerability. For abuse-related content, use pseudonyms, blur photos, and omit location details.
- Avoid identifying communal or cultural details unless inherently essential.
- Sensationalism, gore, and inducement for media content use are strictly prohibited.

2. Consent

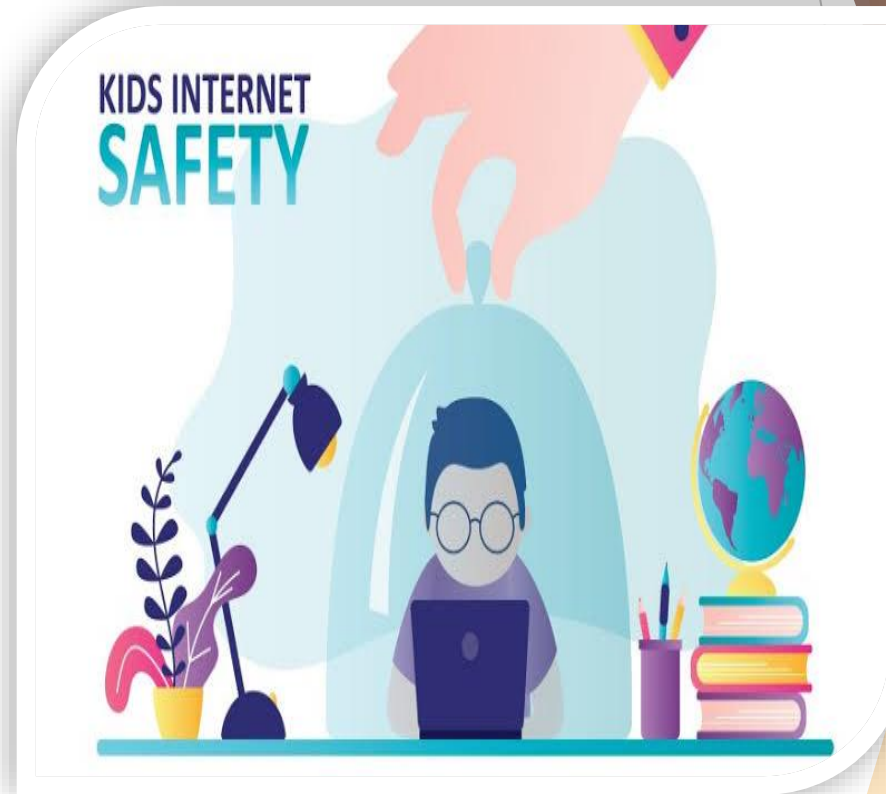
- Obtain informed consent from children and their guardians before capturing media. No incentives should be used.
- Children must understand what they're consenting to.
- Consent can be withdrawn at any time, halting all media use and circulation.
- Institutional consent is required when photographing children in institutions.
- Media from public places with children may proceed without explicit consent.

3. External Guidelines

- Media taken by agents must be credited to the organization (CRY) and ideally done in presence of a member.
- Agents must be briefed on and agree to the Child Safeguarding Policy (CSP) as a clause of their contract.
- Hired child artists must be protected. No child should be filmed without proper consent and documentation.

4. Storage• Media must be stored securely, accessible only to authorized personnel and transferred under high security.• Content must only be used for its intended purpose. Supervisors are accountable for its safe storage.• Consent lasts for 5 years, after which it is renewed. Additionally, media must be sorted by year and renewed after expiry.

5. Interviews/Reporting/Publication• Avoid unannounced visits.• Interviews should serve the child's best interest and not worsen vulnerabilities.• Conduct interviews respectfully, with guardian supervision, consent, and a basic script.• No coercion allowed; for repeated interviews, a CSP expert should be present.



ANNEXURE 4 - READY RECKONER/CHECKLIST FOR USAGE OF PHOTOGRAPHS/FILMS AND CASE STORIES

1. Informed Consent

- Consent from the child and their parents/legal guardians is obtained without any incentives.

2. Case Stories

- Success stories may use real first names, district, and state of the children involved, avoiding specific details that affect privacy.
- In sensitive cases (abuse, trafficking, etc.), pseudonyms are used and photos are blurred before publication.

3. Use of Photographs/Videos/Films/Interviews

- Children must be portrayed respectfully, with a trusted adult present.
- For adults (18+), media can be shared with consent. Abuse-related content uses pseudonyms and blurred photos.

4. Withdrawal of Consent and Content Circulation

- If consent is withdrawn at any time, all related content must be removed.
- Normally, content sharing is allowed only through verified organizational channels, not for personal use.



ANNEXURE 5: WORKING WITH CHILD ACTORS

CRY Child Safeguarding Policy ensure safety and well-being of children in CRY-commissioned audio-visual content.

- Child Actors should provide hourly breaks between shifts. Ensure access to food, water, gender-specific toilets, and age-appropriate recreational materials. Ensure availability of a first aid provider or doctor for emergencies.
- Key Regulation (as per Child Labour Act, 2017) is no child to work for more than 5 hours/day or 3 hours without rest. No work allowed between 7 p.m. and 8 a.m., or on days when the child already worked elsewhere. Permission and declaration must be obtained from District Magistrate. Safety, health, nutrition, education, and protection from exploitation must be ensured.
- At least 20% of child's income to be saved in a fixed deposit in their name. Child must be accompanied by a parent/guardian. Child specialist/counselor to be made available when needed.

ANNEXURE 6: CHILD PROTECTION IN EVENTS

Events must be child-appropriate and aligned with organizational goals.

- Obtain written parental consent; share event details with children. Conduct risk assessments and have emergency plans in place.
- Ensure legal permissions, structural safety, and clear signage. Arrange safe transport with proper documentation and escorts.
- Provide clean toilets, drinking water, food, lighting, and first aid. All volunteers must be trained, oriented, and easily identifiable.
- Respect children's privacy; no photos or videos without consent.



ANNEXURE 7 : RISK ASSESSMENT FRAMEWORK

The Risk Assessment Framework aims to safeguard children by systematically identifying, assessing, and managing risks in all organizational spaces and programs involving children. Key components include:

1. Risk Assessment:

- Methodologically identifies risks (e.g., abuse, hazards) and addresses them through removal, minimization, or management.
- Conducted when new child-involved programs are conceptualized and Periodic reviews of existing programs/spaces .

2. Risk Parameters:

- Infrastructure- includes physical hazards like stairs, electrical fittings.
- Personnel- escorts, staff, volunteers, guests.
- Program Activity -risks tied to activity nature, e.g., outdoor dehydration.
- Information- data security, abuse reporting protocols.
- Organizational Culture- transparency, compliance with child rights.

3. Steps for Risk Management:

- Identify sub-factors- within each parameter (e.g., fire hazards under Infrastructure).
- Involve all stakeholders- including children, to assess hazards and perceptions of risk.
- Determine vulnerable groups-children more at risk in specific contexts.
- Rank risks(low/medium/high) based on - severity of consequences (priority) and Likelihood of occurrence.
- Manage risks - by taking no action (low risk, benefits outweigh risks),Monitoring (low risk),Modifying activities/policies (medium/high risk) and Halting activities (medium/high risk).

This framework ensures a structured approach to child safety, emphasizing proactive risk mitigation and stakeholder collaboration.

ANNEXURE 8 : ONLINE SAFETY OF CHILDREN

- Objectives :
 - Ensure online safety for children participating in organizational events, webinars, conferences, or online study classes.
 - Protect children from risks associated with internet use, including exploitation, harassment, or privacy breaches.

1. Event Participation Guidelines:

- Selection of Children:
 - Vulnerable children (e.g., survivors of trafficking, abuse, or labor) must not be interviewed or identified in public forums.
 - Avoid sharing personal backgrounds or identifiable details (e.g., village, landmarks).
- Documentation:
 - Obtain informed consent from parents/guardians and children.
 - Clearly explain the purpose and expectations of the event to both parties.



- Preparation:

- Conduct child-friendly orientations and mock interviews to familiarize children with the event format.

- Restrict personal information sharing: children may use only their first name and district/state (e.g., “Sita from Odisha”).

- Ensure no digital footprints (e.g., recordings, screenshots) are left post-event.

- Program Management:

- Events must be invitation-only or require registration to control access.

- Zoom/Platform Rules:

- Disable screen-sharing and chat for participants.

- Use waiting rooms; only hosts can admit attendees.

- Remove disruptive participants immediately.

- Avoid sharing event links publicly.

2. Online Study/Support Classes:

- Child Safety:

- Use first names only; no sharing of phone numbers among participants.

- Explain meeting structures and etiquette in advance.

- Volunteer Restrictions:

- Contact children only during pre-approved timings.

- No personal interactions, social media contact, or meetings outside designated spaces.

3. Common Guidelines:

Use organizational devices/accounts when possible; if using personal devices, limit identifiers to first name and organization. Provide digital literacy training to children on online safety and reporting risks. Report any violations to regional or CRY CSD RA teams. Volunteers must consult core teams before using new platforms.

ANNEXURE 9: HUMAN RESOURCE

Recruitment and selection

This procedure is to ensure that —

- (i) the candidates are aware of CRY 's commitment to child protection and (ii) to confirm that there's no child protection violation in candidate's background.

This procedure further includes -Advertisement for a position, interview/ written tests, reference check, appointment.

Personnel Records

The following should be there in the personnel record –

- a) Resume and photograph
- b) Duly signed appointment letter and CSP form
- c) Contact information
- d) Proof of identity, residence, qualification and work experience
- e) Duly signed reference check report.

Training and development

This procedure includes –

- Induction covering CSP duties and child protection.
- Briefing on the latest child protection issues, trends and frameworks.
- Training needs assessment must include child protection.

Disciplinary action

Any inquiry/action on child abuse or CSP violation will be addressed as per the Child Safeguarding Policy.

ANNEXURE 10 PARTNERSHIPS AND ASSOCIATES

Program Partnerships

- Assessment of Child Protection orientation before partnerships.
- Agreements must include adherence to CSP and related SOP's.
- A stepwise implementation of Child Safeguarding Policy –
 - i) Year 1 - CSP adherence, training, basic redressal mechanisms.
 - ii) Year 2 - further training, technical support and self-assessment.
 - iii) Year 3 - Full CSP adherence. Any violation by staff member / personnel of partner organisation must be handled as per CSP redressal process. Violation may result in suspension and termination governed by the GSS , and FIR by CRY if the partner fails to act on violations. Contracts with vendors, consultants, service providersReference checks, identity verification as per CSP SOP for Human Resources. Background checks for those who interact with children. All contracts must include CSP adherence clauses. No engagement with individuals or entities employing child labour.



Donors, visitors, and volunteers

Donors should be informed of CSP for visits and publication. Visitors, volunteers and donors should follow the norms for photography and videography. Sensitive / harmful questions should be avoided. They must respect and adhere to local traditions and way of life. Must be accompanied by CRY / partner staff.

Alliance and Network

Any memorandum must define CSP applicability. Organization funded by CRY are subject to CSP. Coordinators must brief partners on CSP.

Children

Children must be made aware to identify threats of child abuse, respond to abuse and violations, report violations to trusted adults. They should be educated about child rights and reporting procedures. Child friendly versions of CSP should be made available.

ANNEXURE 11: STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE- INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL REPORTING PROCESS

- The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) of CRY includes both internal and external reporting processes to prevent any act of abuse conducted by one person within or outside the context of the organization.
- In case of Internal Reporting Process the child themselves, parents, stakeholders, cry staff or any other person can report the matter as immediately as possible and not more than within 24 hours to the designated authority (DA). In case if the the DA or DAs are the perpetrator, then directly to Human Resource Director or CEO.



Within 48 hours the DA or the higher authority would respond to the report and will decide whether the case is internal or external. If internal, assessment would be made of the severity of the issue and necessary steps would be taken including formation of investigation committee, report to statutory bodies, legal advice if needed. This whole internal investigation process should be completed within a month. For example, During a program, a child disclosed to a CRY partner field animator that the CRY XXX manager had touched her inappropriately during training. Now the child or any other person can report the alleged act of sexual harassment activity being done by a fellow staff as per the disclosure of the child to the DAs or the HR Director.

- External reporting process addresses issues of child protection outside the contexts of organization but within the program areas. For example, if one of the child in CRY program areas is being abused by stranger or someone who is not CRY representative. These types of child protection concerns outside the organization will be dealt through CRY's programs. In External Reporting Process CRY representative who receives the disclosure will report the incident of abuse to the designated authorities of CRY NGO partner, project holder, executive director of the NGO, or to Child line or local police station. Afterwards necessary steps would be taken according to the severity of the matter.

ANNEXURE 12: VOLUNTEER AND INTERN ONBOARDING VIS A VIS CSP

CRY usually receives volunteers from both CRY website and Personal Emails. Once the volunteer request is received, there are few steps to be followed.

Step 1: Onboarding

Volunteers receive an email with orientation details and links. Orientation covers the Induction PPT, CSP norms, and Code of Conduct. Registration forms must be filled, and duration/compliance explained.

Step 2: Working with Children

Volunteers working with children attend a child protection session, are assigned a reporting authority, and follow conduct and photography guidelines. Regular reviews and community communication post-assignment are essential.

Step 3: Consent Form

Consent from children, parents, or project partners allows participation and media use. Blanket consent may be used where needed.

Step 4: Photography

Only designated volunteers may photograph children, with prior consent and CRY norms followed.

Step 5: Reference Check

Volunteers upload a recommendation letter and referee details. Admin/front desk may verify and log responses if needed.



The End!

